

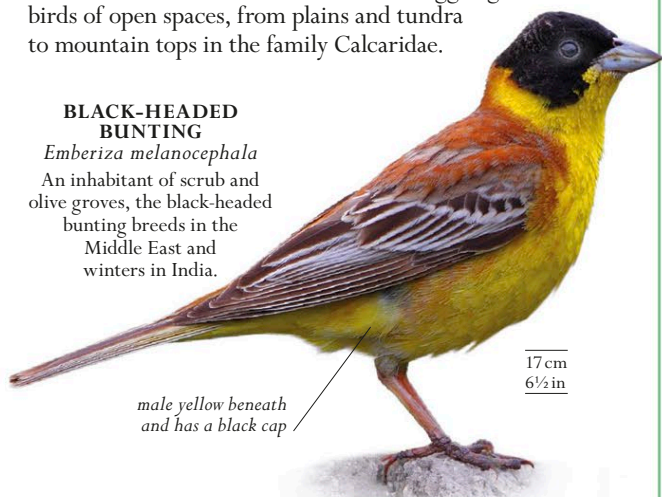
BUNTINGS AND RELATIVES

True buntings of the Old World in the family Emberizidae are mostly ground-feeding seed-eaters. Longspurs, in both Old and New Worlds, are similar short-legged ground birds of open spaces, from plains and tundra to mountain tops in the family Calcariidae.

BLACK-HEADED BUNTING

Emberiza melanocephala

An inhabitant of scrub and olive groves, the black-headed bunting breeds in the Middle East and winters in India.



male yellow beneath and has a black cap

17 cm
6½ in



15 cm
6 in

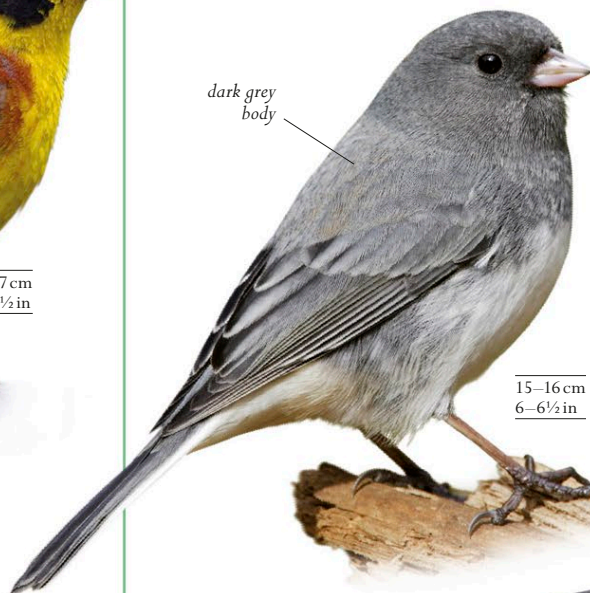
LAPLAND LONGSPUR

Calcarius lapponicus

Relatives of buntings, longspurs have been named for their long hind claw. This species has a circumpolar distribution during the breeding season.

AMERICAN SPARROWS

Birds in the family Passerellidae resemble Old World buntings rather than true sparrows, especially in the bill structure, with a small, sharp upper mandible and often slightly kinked cutting edge. Many also have striped head patterns, with or without streaked flanks – others are more uniform in colour. They search for seeds while hopping on the ground.



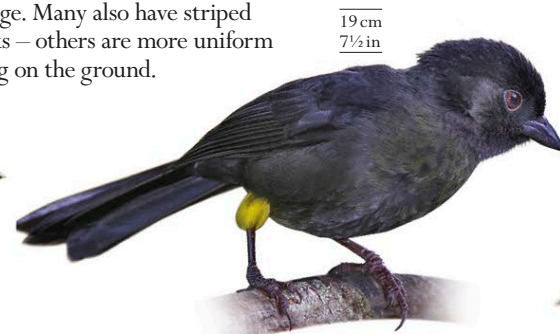
dark grey body

15–16 cm
6–6½ in

DARK-EYED JUNCO

Junco hyemalis

Juncos are grey-brown, ground-flocking N. American sparrows. This species, locally called the snowbird, is a common winter visitor of garden bird feeders.



19 cm
7½ in

YELLOW-THIGGED FINCH

Pselliophorus tibialis

A noisy, tropical member of the American sparrow family, this species is found only in the montane rainforests of Costa Rica and Panama.



22 cm
9 in

SPOTTED TOWHEE

Pipilo maculatus

Towhees are long-tailed American sparrows. The spotted towhee is a reddish brown-sided bird found in thicket habitats across N. America.

TANAGERS AND RELATIVES

An American family, the Thraupidae consist of gaudily coloured tanagers, found in the forests of tropical South America. These finch-related birds have evolved to exploit a range of food sources, including fruits, insects, seeds, and nectar.



11 cm
4¼ in

VARIABLE SEED-EATER

Sporophila corvina

Belonging to a group of tropical American, stubby-billed seed-eaters, this bird has a variable plumage pattern.



14 cm
5½ in

GREEN HONEYCREEPER

Chlorophanes spiza

This stocky species lives in forest canopy and uses its stout, decurved bill to eat fruits. It is often seen in mixed flocks of tanagers.



18–19 cm
7–7½ in

SCARLET TANAGER

Piranga olivacea

In most species of *Piranga* tanager, the males turn red during breeding. This migratory species is from N. America.



18 cm
7 in

WESTERN TANAGER

Piranga ludoviciana

This bird breeds in western N. America and overwinters in C. America. It is the only *Piranga* tanager where the breeding male is predominantly yellow.

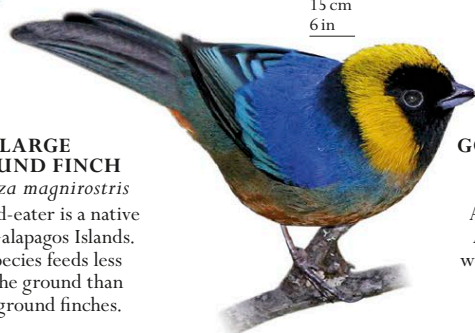
BLACK-MASKED FINCH

Coryphaspiza melanotis

A ground-feeding finch of grassland habitats in central S. America, this species has been assigned to the tanager family.



14 cm
5½ in

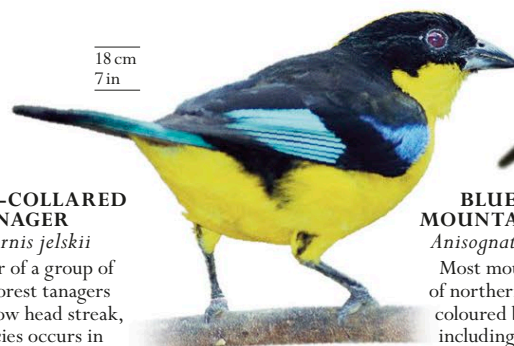


15 cm
6 in

LARGE GROUND FINCH

Geospiza magnirostris

This seed-eater is a native of the Galapagos Islands. The species feeds less from the ground than other ground finches.



18 cm
7 in

GOLDEN-COLLARED TANAGER

Iridosornis jelskii

A member of a group of Andean forest tanagers with a yellow head streak, this species occurs in Peru and Bolivia.

BLUE-WINGED MOUNTAIN TANAGER

Anisognathus somptuosus

Most mountain tanagers of northern S. America are coloured blue and yellow, including this inhabitant of montane rainforests.